

"Training at our organisation is carried out for fresh folks for their optimum performance and upgradation of skills. We have different training modules such as class-based, Web-based, and on-the-job kind of training," informs Brooks. The duration of the training period is usually between two and ten weeks, depending upon the nature of the training module.

"We at Oracle have special training modules designed for three levels—Fundamental, Advanced, and Specialist. All are short-term, intensively-designed modules for those who want to have in-depth knowledge and hands-on skills with DBMS products," says Ambastha.

Designation And Remuneration

The designations awarded depend on the performance and capabilities of the employee. They differ across organisations and industries. The fields branch out into technical and business-oriented profiles at the middle level, where one can decide upon an area of expertise.

Entry Level: In programming, be it a small application or utility or a big ERP or database package, the majority of the designations remain the same throughout the industry.

For database management, software programming and development, administration, designing and solutions, consulting and business solutions of DBMS software, the growth path is similar to that of in other professions.

At this level, most tasks require core-to-field kind of activities like programming, coding, deployment of and working with database applications, end-user support, data backup, and more. Posts awarded in programming would be associate software engineer, software engineer, etc. These people will be part of a project team, but handle specific modules independently.

For database administration, the designations awarded would be technical support, technical expert/specialist, solution architect, designer, and so on. Similarly, for a consulting domain like data warehousing, business intelligence and data mining, one can be a consultant (technical or business), research assistant, assistant analyst, and such.

At this level, the average time taken to reach one position up would be a minimum of one to two years. The average monthly salary a fresher can expect is between Rs 20,000 to Rs 40,000.

Middle Level: As one moves higher, the area of expertise branches out into technical or business-related; one has to choose. Database professionals at these levels would be in charge of the testing and validation of functions such as design, solutions, data backup, security, etc. They lead a team of juniors.

The majority of individuals at the middle level lead single or multiple projects, resolve technical issues, scope out the functionality of databases, estimate resources, derive solutions to technical and business issues relating to databases, and so forth.

Designations awarded to those in software development, database administration, solutions, design, and architecture would be senior software engineer/developer, project lead, senior data architect, senior solution architect, and

Specialisations

Data Warehousing is the collection of non-volatile information of business processes such as the cost per unit, expenses incurred per employee in a particular year/month/quarter, etc., so that they can be extracted, analysed, processed, and used for further understanding of the data. It can also be seen as the technique of gathering data and maintaining it for business purposes such as purchase, payment, and other strategic decisions.

Business Intelligence (BI) is a process where programs and systems are used for gathering, storing, analysing, providing access to, and retrieving large data within an enterprise. The databases are used for

strategic planning and analysis of the available data at various levels to aid decision-making. Solution support activities such as online analytical processing (OLAP), statistical analysis, forecasting, query reports, error reporting, and decision support can be performed using BI applications.

Data Mining refers to the process of drawing useful data patterns and information from large databases using mathematical techniques. From large databases, the known relationship patterns such as consumers' common interests, their buying behaviour, etc. are extracted and then analysed for better decision-making and other strategic activities.



The appraisal and promotions are procured by individuals as per their ability based on their assessment of work performance and contribution to a project"

Seema Ambastha
Director - Sales
Consulting (Database
Technologies)
Oracle India Pvt. Ltd.

such. For consultants in data warehousing, business intelligence, and data mining, the designations would be senior consultant, consulting head, head architect (solutions), and so on.

The time taken to advance to the next level is three to five years, and pay scales are Rs 45,000 to Rs 80,000 per month.

Senior Level: Here, the individual would be responsible for and lead all the teams below him. He/she would lead a product group—or group of solutions—to deliver cutting-edge solutions in accordance with the demands of clients from different industry verticals. These professionals take all strategic decisions relating to projects to be undertaken or those already running. Designations awarded in development, database designing, solution architecting, and administration of databases would be director of engineering, vice president (database technologies), or country head/manager (database package).

Consultants are designated the domain consultant, principal consultant, president/vice president (consulting), and so forth. The average time take to get here is more than six or eight years in a particular domain. Remuneration starts from Rs 85,000 per month, with the upper limit decided by the organisation.

Summing It Up

According to Gartner, the global DBMS market will generate \$13.2 billion (Rs 61,400 crore) by 2009, and the DBMS software market has a compound annual growth rate of 10.3 per cent, bringing the market to \$1.3 billion (Rs 6,000 crore) in new license revenue by 2009. One can sum up from the figures that there is immense scope in databases as a career option.

In India, many multinationals are bringing in their operational centres such as country offices, research labs, and such. And there will always be a dearth of qualified and skilled database professionals.

We've said the scope is immense, that the remuneration is attractive, and we've indicated the field is challenging. So what does a career in databases sound like? ■

samir_makwana@thinkdigit.com